GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

June 26th, 2026
Week 26
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QUOTE of the WEEK

"The pessimist complains about the wind; the optimist expects it to change; the realist adjusts the sails."

- William Arthur

Highlights:

- **Strait fills.**
- **Oil sinks.**
- **Queue builds.**
- **Yards wait.**

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-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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TRAFFIC DOUBLES, YARDS WAIT

The war is over; the paperwork is taking longer than the peace. The formal signing of the US-Iran agreement at Bürgenstock in Switzerland was abruptly postponed last Friday, with Vice President Vance turning his plane around over what the White House called unresolved logistical issues, even as the interim memorandum remained in effect and implementation accelerated on the water. Vessel traffic through the Strait of Hormuz doubled in 24 hours to its highest level since late February, with at least 34 ships exiting into the Gulf of Oman against a pre-war daily average of 110. The Vice President noted that Iran had, for a second consecutive night, declined to fire on any vessel. The ships, having no plane to turn around, simply kept sailing.

Brent crude has fallen below USD 74 per barrel, its lowest since before the war began and now only about 7% above its pre-conflict level, having shed more than 20% in June alone. WTI trades below USD 70. The IEA estimates the UAE is already exporting at roughly 85% of pre-war volumes and warns of a coming glut; OPEC's secretary general rejects both the glut and the notion of a demand peak, leaving the two agencies agreed on nothing except that the other is mistaken. Beneath the collapse sits an oddity: US crude inventories have fallen to their lowest since 1984, with Cushing below operational minimums, a tightness the price has chosen to ignore in favour of the reopening.

Freight has continued its orderly descent from the war peak. The Baltic Dry Index eased to 2,634 on June 24 from the June 1 high of 3,222, with daily Capesize earnings settling near USD 35,800 as the disrupted long-haul trades that inflated demand through the conflict normalise. The geared segments most relevant to recycling held firm, with Supramax near USD 21,400 and Handysize near USD 17,000 per day. The Capesize premium that kept the largest ageing tonnage trading has now fully unwound, and the freight side of the equation that held candidates at sea through the war has, like the fuel side, returned toward its pre-war shape.

The currency picture has acquired a second force. The Indian Rupee firmed to a six-week high near 94.30 on the oil collapse and improving capital inflows, the Pakistani Rupee strengthened to a fresh 2026 best near 278.10, and the Bangladeshi Taka held the floor of its band near 122.70. But the dollar itself is now strengthening: the Dollar Index has reached its highest in more than a year as US inflation climbed to 4.2%, a three-year high, and markets price roughly a 75% chance of a Federal Reserve rate increase by September. The Turkish Lira, domestic to its core, slid past 46 toward 46.40, a fresh record. The energy shock that drove inflation across the sub-continent has ended; America's inflation, meanwhile, has reached a three-year high. The fire did not go out. It changed address. Detailed country reads follow on pages 2 through 5.

This is Ashura week, and the sub-continent's yards are largely closed for the holiday and slowed by the monsoon both. Around them, two queues are forming. One is the growing line of cargoes waiting to move through a reopening Hormuz, which analysts now watch by the day. The other is the deferred wave of recycling candidates that the war's end is finally releasing, with the Andhika Paramesti sold to Bangladesh at USD 460 last week the first of what should become many. Between the tonnage and the beach stands the monsoon, which serves both queues with equal indifference and will not lift before September. The strait fills. The queue builds. The yards, for a few more weeks, wait. The war that would not end has ended. The season that always ends has not.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 26 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

TAKA HOLDS, WAVE FORMS

Taka holds.

Bangladesh enters Week 26 with USD/BDT near the floor of its band at approximately 122.70, the Taka having now held the 122.74 to 123.18 range intact through the war and into the peace without a single breach. The collapse in Brent below USD 74, down more than 20% on the month, removes the imported-energy pressure that was the band's principal external risk, and the broad strengthening of the dollar on US rate expectations has been absorbed without strain. Foreign exchange reserves near USD 34.12 billion remain the operative buffer. Local steel plate prices moved from BDT 65,000 to BDT 67,000 through the week, with the USD equivalent rising from approximately USD 535 to USD 551 per ton, the mill complex still taking direction from a post-war scrap market that is searching for its floor rather than setting one.

Wave forms.

The first concrete evidence of the deferred tonnage wave has arrived. The Andhika Paramesti, a 9,369 LDT bulker, was sold to Bangladesh at USD 460 per LDT on an as-is Sambu basis, the first reported sale into the basin since the strait reopened and a marker that the candidate pool the war held back is beginning to release. It is one vessel, not a flood, and it lands in a week shortened by Ashura and constrained by the monsoon, but the direction is established: with the bunker-cost floor and the Capesize premium both deflating, owners who held ageing tonnage at sea through the conflict now have materially less reason to keep holding it. Chattogram is positioned to absorb the wave when it builds, the question being one of timing rather than appetite.

Holiday slows.

Ashura, observed June 26, has brought Chattogram's cash-buyer activity to its customary holiday pause, layered atop the monsoon's seasonal reduction in beaching cycles. The Letter of Credit pipeline remains in its most permissive posture of the year, full plot capacity is available, and the currency is the most stable in the basin, which means the only binding constraint on Bangladesh converting the incoming wave into beached tonnage is the calendar. The structural setup for the third quarter is the strongest the market has carried since before February: strong demand, cleared financing, a stable Taka, a reopening supply pipeline, and a monsoon that, unlike the war, has a known end date. The wave forms offshore. The beach waits for the sky.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

RUPEE FIRMS, DOLLAR RESISTS

Rupee firms.

USD/INR firmed to a six-week high near 94.30, extending the rupee's recovery from the 96.97 record of May 21 as Brent's fall below USD 74, the lowest since before the war, fed directly into the external-account arithmetic of an economy that imports more than 80% of its crude. Brent is down more than 20% in June, and India's import bill, struck against pre-war oil rather than the USD 126 peak, is repricing materially in the rupee's favour. Improving capital flows have reinforced the move: investment into Indian debt has strengthened and the one-sided dollar demand that pressured the rupee through the war has eased, with traders willing for the first time in months to take positions on both sides.

Dollar resists.

The rupee's advance is now meeting a genuine counterforce. The Dollar Index has climbed to its highest in more than 1 year as US inflation reached 4.2%, a three-year high, and markets moved to price roughly a 75% probability of a Federal Reserve rate increase by September under the new chair. Foreign institutional investors remained net sellers of Indian equities through the week even as bond inflows improved, capping the rupee's gains. The oil tailwind that should, in isolation, drive the rupee well through 94 is being met by a dollar strengthening on America's own inflation problem. The rupee is winning the argument it can control and being held back by the one it cannot.

Alang resumes.

Local steel plate prices at Alang softened to an INR 36,500 to 37,000 range, with the USD equivalent near USD 386 to USD 392 per ton, the post-war collapse in energy and scrap sentiment outweighing the firmer rupee. India remains the lowest-priced sub-continent destination. The port saw genuine activity through the prior fortnight, with multiple deliveries including the 41,478 LDT Octans tanker working through Alang, evidence that the reopening is beginning to move tonnage even as the monsoon caps the beaching rate. Alang enters the post-war quarter with the basin's deepest yard capacity, more than 110 valid Statements of Compliance, a recovering currency, and a deflating bunker floor. The rains govern July's beaching pace. The reopening governs the supply that will meet it.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

RUPEE LEADS, PREMIUM GONE

Rupee leads.

Pakistan opens the post-war period as the basin's strongest currency. USD/PKR firmed to approximately 278.10, a fresh 2026 best and now stronger by roughly 2.25% year-to-date, extending the rupee's distinction as the only sub-continent currency to have appreciated against the dollar across both the war and its aftermath. The collapse in Brent below USD 74 is now driving the weekly oil import bill, which Prime Minister Sharif quantified at USD 800 million at the war's height, back toward its pre-conflict level, relieving the external-account pressure that produced April's double-digit CPI shock at its source. The State Bank's rate posture and disciplined reserve management carried the rupee through the conflict and are now compounding with the oil relief.

Premium gone.

The specific advantage that made Gadani the basin's firmest market through the war has now substantially gone. The Gulf proximity premium, which compounded while Hormuz was closed and Gulf-region tonnage reassessed its routing, has eroded in real time as the strait reopens: with vessel traffic through Hormuz doubling in a day and the UAE exporting at 85% of pre-war volumes, the maritime geography that handed Gadani a wartime locational edge has returned to its ordinary shape. The strategic clock the Weekly began flagging a month ago has, in effect, run out. Gadani now competes where it always competes in peacetime, on price and on compliance, and the wartime premium that lifted its position is no longer a factor in the basin's pricing.

Position resets.

Local steel plate prices at PKR 195,000 per ton held, with the USD equivalent near USD 701 per ton on the firm rupee, Gadani retaining the firmest absolute pricing in the basin for the moment. Three HKC-certified yards remain operational with further certifications in the pipeline, and the Ron at 21,502 LDT has worked through the yard. Pakistan enters the post-war competition from the strongest position any destination held during the conflict, but it enters a normalised market: the deferred tonnage wave will route on price and compliance once the monsoon lifts, the wartime premium is spent, and Gadani's share of the coming supply will be determined by fundamentals rather than by geography. Pakistan won the war quarter. The peace quarter will be a different contest, played on different ground.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

LIRA SLIDES PAST 46, NICHE HOLDS

Lira slides.

Turkey enters Week 26 with USD/TRY having extended its slide past 46 toward approximately 46.40, deeper into record territory, the lira down roughly 17% over the past 12 months. The peace and the oil collapse that lifted every Hormuz-exposed currency in the basin have done almost nothing for the lira, whose pressures remain domestic and structural. The Central Bank of Turkey's managed-depreciation framework continues to function as designed, the slide orderly and the level steadily worse, against a strengthening global dollar that compounds the local weakness. The lira made new lows through the war, through the ceasefire, and now through the peace, indifferent to all 3.

Energy helps, barely.

The single channel through which the war's end genuinely assists Turkey is energy. Brent below USD 74, against the USD 107 of mid-May and the USD 126 peak, materially lowers the imported-inflation pulse that drove the April and May CPI acceleration, and a sustained post-war oil environment is the most plausible disinflation tailwind the TCMB has had all year. With the May CPI at 32.61%, the year-end forecast range suspended, and the policy rate held at an effective 40% overnight, the oil relief is welcome but marginal against an inflation structure measured in the thirties. The fire that the sub-continent has now escaped still burns in Ankara, and cheaper oil lowers the flame without putting it out.

Niche persists.

At USD 266 to USD 288 per LDT across vessel types, Aliaga remains structurally uncompetitive for mainstream tonnage, and the post-war landscape only sharpens the point. The deferred wave of recycling candidates that the war's end is releasing will route overwhelmingly to the sub-continent on the price differential once the monsoon lifts, and Aliaga's share of it will continue to be set by EU regulation and Basel Convention compliance rather than by price. Turkey occupied a separate market through the entire conflict and occupies the same separate market in its aftermath. Of everything the war changed in the basin, Aliaga's position is the one variable it left exactly where it found it.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 26 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Steady**	458-463 / LDT	478-483 / LDT	488-493 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	443-448 / LDT	463-468 / LDT	473-478 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	418-423 / LDT	438-443 / LDT	448-453 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Softening**	266-268 / LDT	276-278 / LDT	286-288 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *Ship recycling at Alang has helped avoid the need for* ***over 100 million tons of raw iron ore extraction****, equivalent to around* ***4 years of output*** *from a 25 million-ton-per-year iron ore mine.*

- *The* ***72.55 million MT of CO_2 emissions avoided*** *through ship recycling at Alang is more than* ***17 times the annual CO_2 emissions*** *of all Pacific island small states combined.*

- *The* ***124.5 million barrels of oil saved*** *through ship recycling at Alang is equivalent to* ***more than 84,000 operating days for an 8,000 TEU containership****, using an approximate bunker-consumption benchmark.*

IMPORTANT DATES

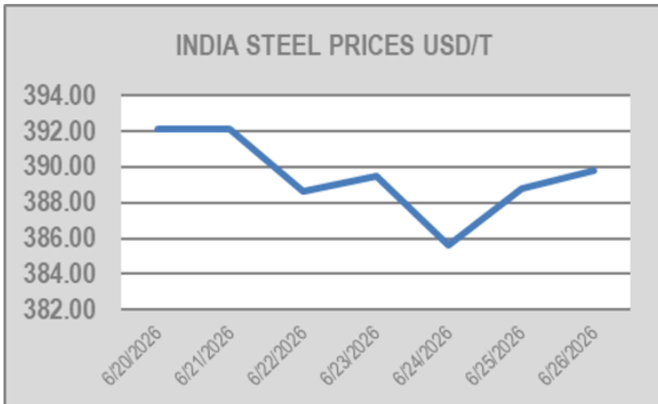
INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 15 – Independence Day	June 27 – July 05 July 11 – July 20

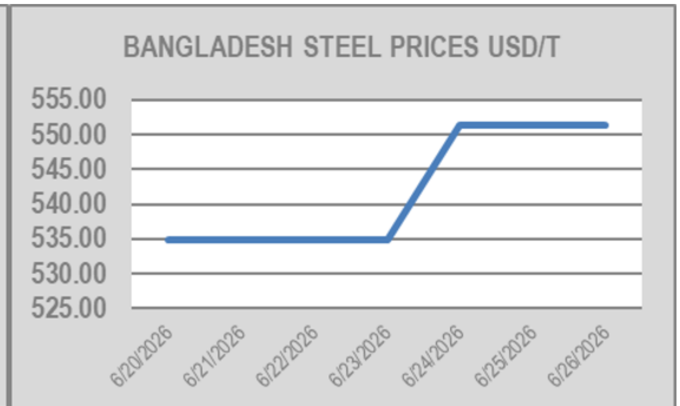
BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 05 - July Uprising Day August 26 - Eid-e-Milad-un-Nabi	June 30 – July 03 July 14 – July 17

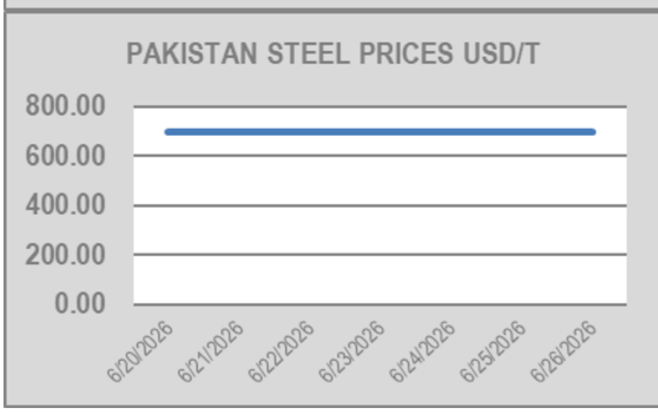
BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
August 14 – Independence Day August 25 – Eid Milad-un-Nabi	July 15 - Democracy and National Unity Day

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
ALANG - Port Position as of June 26, 2026				
No new vessels reported.				
CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of June 26, 2026				
No.	**VESSEL NAME**	**LDT**	**TYPE**	**STATUS**
1	Thane	10,160	Wood Chip Carrier	Arrived June 25
2	Zamrud	28,858	LNG Gas Carrier	Arrived June 25
3	ERGY	31,341	LNG Tanker	Arrived June 23
4	Pearl 1	5,890	General Cargo	Arrived June 20
5	Mai 1	1,844	Tanker	Arrived June 18
6	Xin Hai 18	1,543	General Cargo	Arrived June 17
7	Neptune Starlight	2,712	General Cargo	Arrived May 26
GADANI - Port Position as of June 26, 2026				
No.	**VESSEL NAME**	**LDT**	**TYPE**	**STATUS**
1	Jenny Lucky	7,176	Bulk Carrier	Arrived June 21
2	Ladonna	5,191	Bulk Carrier	Arrived June 21

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
6/20/2026	392.16	37,000.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	316.50
6/21/2026	392.16	37,000.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	316.50
6/22/2026	388.68	36,800.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	316.50
6/23/2026	389.53	36,900.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	316.50
6/24/2026	385.59	36,500.00	696.43	195,000.00	551.44	67,000.00	314.54
6/25/2026	388.77	36,700.00	696.43	195,000.00	551.44	67,000.00	314.54
6/26/2026	389.83	36,800.00	696.43	195,000.00	551.44	67,000.00	314.54







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